



KARC - Kingsport Amateur Radio Club
Website: W4TRC.org
Meeting Minutes

Meeting Date: June 11, 2026

Location: Toy F. Reid (Eastman Rec Center)

400 S Wilcox Dr, Kingsport

Start time: 7PM

Adjourned: 9PM

Presentation: WiresX - Todd Malone (KE4CCB)

Attendance: 22

Meeting Opened: Pledge of Allegiance and Prayer (*Special prayer requests to the families of David Broome, Garland Caudill, Tom Price, and Jack Rutherford, who recently became silent keys.*)

New Business:

- *With great sorrow, we acknowledge the passing of two beloved KARC members and friends, Jack Rutherford (W4LMY) and Tom Price (KI4CVU). At this time the KARC extends fervent prayer and condolences to their families and friends.*

- **UPDATE:** We will no longer be hosting the W1AW event in person, as too many complications arose with finding a location suitable for the club's needs.
- **UPDATE:** The location (and hours) for Field Day has changed! Due to issues with the accessibility changes at Warriors Park, the decision was made to move Field Day to Netherland Inn. This site will not allow for 24h operations, therefore, hours for the event have been posted on the W4TRC website. We are still looking for volunteers to help cook the hotdogs and hamburgers, or bring a covered dish. **We ask that if you plan to attend Field Day, even if you are not bringing anything, please RSVP so that we know how many to expect.**
forms.w4trc.org/field-day
- Monthly meeting attendance has decreased lately, and Larry Dale would like suggestions on what could be done to improve attendance in the future. A notebook and pen was passed around for suggestions. ***Thanks to Joshua, we now have a comments section added to the W4TRC website where you can anonymously provide comments, concerns, or suggestions.*
- Club Checking, Savings, and CD balances reported by the Treasurer, Rick Curtis.
- We currently have **44** paid and active members.
- At this time we need to update the Eastman Credit Union Club accounts to allow access for our 2026 club president, Larry Dale, and relinquish access from former club presidents Neil Weber, and Greg Johnson.

Repeater Outages and/or Updates:

- At this time, the repeaters are online, however, power is “iffy”, and we are currently waiting on parts. The wiring does need to be replaced, and could have been damaged due surge or lightning, we are unsure of which. Internet setup is scheduled for this fall. At a previous meeting the question arose of possibly raising the antennas, but the antennas are as high as they can go for now. We are looking into adding another section of tower at some point in the future. Will update accordingly.

Upcoming Events:

- The next KARC Monthly Meeting will take place on Thursday, July 09 at 7pm.
 - **Upcoming Presentation:** Ed Fong will give a virtual presentation on VHF antennas via Teams
- The KARC Monthly Foxhunt will be **Saturday, June 20** beginning at 3 pm.
- Field Day will take place during the last weekend of June (**Saturday 06/27 - Sunday 06/28**) at Netherland Inn.

Q&A:

Q: When will we go back to weekly nets?

A: At this time we are unsure of the repeater reliability. Joshua says he is unsure if the repeater will hold up for the net to take place.

Q: What about a simplex net?

A: We would need someone with elevation. We previously had a simplex net weekly following the 2m weekly net, but then went to monthly before it ultimately ended. At this time we are open to having a simplex net again in the future.

Reminders/F.Y.I.:

- **Club meetings are on the 2nd Thursday each month at the Toy F. Reid Center (400 S Wilcox Dr, Kingsport TN) and begin at 7pm.**
- Club dues are \$20 per individual, and \$30 for family.
- At this time we are not doing a weekly 2 meter net.
- Any questions, comments, or concerns are welcomed and can be directed to: contact@w4trc.org
- Every Wednesday at 12:00 noon a club lunch is held at the John B's Family Kitchen restaurant (formerly Mama's House) located at: 2608 N John B. Dennis Hwy., Kingsport, TN 37660. All are welcome to attend.
- Although the weekly 2m net is not currently active, we do hope to bring it back once the repeater is in good and reliable condition. We need volunteers to act as net control stations, as well as alternate net control stations. George DeVault (W3KPT) is ready and willing to step back into his role as the net control on every 2nd Sunday, but at this time there are no other volunteers. **Despite past suggestions and discussions of moving the net to a different day/time, this has not proven to be beneficial in the past. The 2m net will remain on Sundays at 8:30 pm, when it resumes.*